

RAFAEL CARBAJAL SANCHEZ

UX / Product Designer | Available June 2027
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Portfolio: rafaelsanchez.design

SUMMARY

UX/product designer with Snapchat feature prototyping experience and a deployed AI assistant. Connects user research, interaction design, and React development to build functional product experiences.

EDUCATION

Santa Monica College - Santa Monica, CA Expected June 2027
Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Interaction Design
Google UX Design Certificate, Coursera 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Snap Inc. | Snap Design Academy - Los Angeles, CA Jun - Aug 2026
Design Scholar (Contract)

- Led UX for Resources, a Snapchat local-support concept, partnering with engineering and marketing to take an open prompt to a functional prototype in three weeks.
- Conducted two rounds of partner research and feedback with S.P.Y. and St. Joseph Center; combined findings with usability testing to refine hierarchy, privacy, and service handoffs.
- Integrated the concept across Snap Map, Search, Spotlight, and sharing instead of a standalone hub; presented the prototype and design decisions to 300+ Snap employees.

Plataforma Impact - Mexico City, Mexico (Remote) Mar 2021 - Jan 2022
UX Intern

- Created website layouts and UI for a B2B specialty coffee brand in Figma and implemented front-end updates, refining the work with senior designers on a remote team.

SELECTED DESIGN PROJECTS

Pantri | Grocery Planning App Spring 2026

- Translated Figma designs into an end-to-end React prototype connecting onboarding, meal planning, a digital pantry, and meal completion with simulated purchase and freshness data.
- Interviewed 13 grocery shoppers in-store to shape the core flow around budgeting, produce selection, substitutions, and changing shopping routines.
- Built low- and high-fidelity prototypes to test meal-plan micro-interactions and recovery paths for substitutions, quantity changes, and skipped meals without restarting the weekly plan.

Nibble | AI Portfolio Assistant Summer 2026

- Launched an AI portfolio assistant with conversational routing and contextual case-study links; handled 250+ visitor questions in its first four weeks.
- Developed context selection and response states to guide visitors to relevant projects; Vercel reporting showed project views per visit rising from 1.6 to 2.3 in the first four weeks after launch.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Blocal - Los Angeles, CA Aug 2026 - Present
UX Designer (Volunteer) - Designing and building the organization's website.

SKILLS

Design: Product design, interaction design, prototyping, information architecture, user flows, wireframing, visual design, accessibility

Research: User interviews, usability testing, field research, research synthesis

Development: React, JavaScript, HTML/CSS

Tools: Figma, Claude Code, Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign